

Climbing Medicine

A Practical Guide

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Editors

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 Springer

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Preface



Rock and sport climbing is currently evolving from an individual sport into a mainstream sport. The worldwide boom of bouldering has especially contributed to this increase in popularity, and the number of indoor climbing centers is constantly growing. Unfortunately, climbing's 2020 Olympic debut in Tokyo had to be postponed but the whole climbing community is eagerly awaited the event in 2021.

We, as editors and contributors of this book, are all avid climbers ourselves and have been practicing climbing medicine for many years (some of us approximately 30 years or more). In this capacity, we have not only been treating patients with injuries in climbing clinics but have also been monitoring national teams and supervising competitions. The climbing sport provides many professional challenges, as its pathologies are very sport specific and unique to the sport. Since climbing has only been a professional sport for the last 30 years, many questions about long-term developments and consequences remain unanswered. Based on our clinical knowledge as well as our scientific research of climbing pathologies, we are proud to present the current standards of research in this book.

The English edition of "Climbing Medicine" aims to demonstrate anatomical and biomechanical characteristics of the sport and to analyze the specific injuries and overstrains. Furthermore, we will present the medical, gynecological, and pediatric aspects of the sport. While our book "One Move Too Many" (Schöffl V, Hochholzer T, Lightner S Jr) is in its third edition and is addressed to trainers, athletes, and laypeople, this book targets medical professionals and scientists with a focus on evidence-based knowledge in

climbing medicine, covering a wide range of topics and current research. We are privileged to have received the support of the famous physiologist Professor Phil Watts for Chap. 4, “Physiology.” Phil Watts is a remarkable researcher and his work on climbing physiology has set the standard in climbing. In addition to Prof. Watts, Y. El-Sheikh, the Canadian team doctor, contributed to the chapter on finger injuries, and Thomas Bayer presents diagnostic imaging and all of the newest research from the field of radiology. Our British friends Gareth Jones and Ugo Ehiogu present data and recommendations on rehabilitation and prevention. The very important topic of medical issues in climbing medicine is covered by Thomas Küpper. Michael Simon and Jens Liße contributed valuable insight to various chapters. Our special thanks go to all of the contributors for this great joint effort as well as to Rosamunde Pare for the English language support. Michael Simon, Enrico Haase, and Kilian Reil contributed with numerous photos to illustrate this work, as well as Tiffany Fung did provide illustrations. Finally, we want to thank all of our patients for their trust and support in allowing us to carry out our research with and on them, as well as the teams from our clinics and institutes, research staff, and chiefs of staff for making it possible for us to conduct all of this research.

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WARNING!! THIS BOOK DESCRIBES TRAINING TECHNIQUES FOR DANGEROUS ACTIVITIES. BOTH THE ACTIVITIES AND THE TRAINING TECHNIQUES DESCRIBED CAN CAUSE SERIOUS INJURY AND/OR DEATH.

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If you are unwilling to assume these risks, do not use this book or undertake the activities or the training techniques described herein.

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